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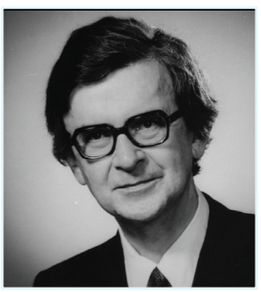
Emil von Behring



Paul Ehrlich



Robert Koch



Niels K.Jerne



Jules J.B.V.Bordet



Max Theiler



Rodney R.Porter

Figure 13.1: Notable Scientists who contributed to the development of Immunology

13.2 Organs of the Immune System

The immune system consists of structurally varied organs that are distributed throughout the body. Based on function, the organs can be divided into primary and secondary lymphoid organs (Figure 13.2). The primary lymphoid organs are responsible for providing the appropriate microenvironments for the development and maturation of antigen sensitive B and T cells. The thymus is the primary lymphoid organ for development of T cells and the bone marrow is the primary lymphoid organ for development of B cells. The secondary lymphoid organs serve as sites where lymphocytes interact with antigen and undergo proliferation and differentiation into antigen specific effector cells. The spleen, lymph nodes and mucosal associated lymphoid tissues (MALT) are secondary lymphoid organs. These are discussed in more detail below.

13.2.1 Primary Lymphoid Organs

a. Thymus

The thymus is a highly organized lymphoid organ located above the heart. The thymus consists of two lobes. Each

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